Invasive species are species that are not native to a certain area, but were brought there somehow. It is necessary to control invasive species because they take away from the food supply of native species, destroy the habitats they invade, and are costly to the economy. Some may argue that invasive species increase biodiversity and therefor should be left alone. The text states "When Dov Sax of Brown University conducted a global study of species invasions on oceanic islands, he found that while the number of birds did sometimes go down after invasions, plant biodiversity usually rose. Typically, such islands now have twice as many plant species as before" (Source 4, lines 40-43). In reality this small benefit of invasive species does not out weigh all the harm they cause.

Invasive species outcompete native species for food. The text states, that carp that were introduced to the Missouri River "feed on plankton" (Source 2 lines 21). The text also states, "Many native fish species such as paddlefish, also feed on plankton. The feeding cycle of the paddlefish is slower than that of the carp" (Source 2, lines 22-23). As a result, the invasive carp feeds on the plankton more often, diminishing the source of food for the paddlefish. The more the carp feed, and the more they reproduce. Overtime, the population of carp will rise so much that the paddlefish will not be able to find food and will die off.

Invasive species also destroy the habitats of native species. The text Source 2 discusses the large rodents called Nutria, which are invasive to North America. The text states, "Nutria eat tall grasses and rushes. These plants are vital to the regions' marshy wetlands. They provide food, nesting sites, and shelter for many organisms" (Source 2 lines 29-31). As a result, native organisms are stripped of their food source and shelter. This greatly affects the natural ecosystem and can

impact the survival rates of native species.

Invasive species are also costly to the economy. The text states, "the cost of biological invasions to the economy of the United States alone is estimated at over $100 billion annually" (Source 3, lines 22-23). These invasions take place in areas all over the world. In order to prevent further costs to the economy, these invasive species should be put under control now.

It is necessary to control invasive species as they cause great harm by eating the food sources of native species, disturbing the habitats they invade, and costing billions of dollars to economies.